

Illuminati

User manual

Find, download and read books that were never under copyright or whose copyright has expired.

Version 1.0 · Windows, macOS, Linux and Android

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1 Welcome

Illuminati is a reading app for Windows, macOS, Linux and Android. It works like the e-book apps you may know, with one difference: every book it offers is free and legal to download, because its copyright has expired or it was never under copyright.

- Over 75,000 books from **Project Gutenberg**, plus **Standard Ebooks**, **Wikisource** and the **Internet Archive**.
- A comfortable reader with highlights, notes, bookmarks, search, a dictionary and translation.
- Your own library, with shelves and reading lists.
- Display and accessibility settings, including a dyslexia-friendly font.
- No account, no subscription and no advertising. Everything is stored on your device.

The interface is available in English, Spanish, French, German, Italian and Portuguese.

2 Getting started

2.1 Installing

- **Windows:** copy the whole `Illuminati` folder to your computer and run `illuminati.exe`. Keep the files next to it; the program needs them.
- **Android:** install the `.apk` file. You may need to allow installing apps from this source in your phone's settings.
- **macOS and Linux:** install the build made for your system.

2.2 The home screen

On a computer the app opens maximized. The home screen has two parts:

1. **Your library** (top): the books you have downloaded, most recently read first, with a progress bar. The **Library & shelves** button opens your whole library.
2. **Discover free books** (below): a search box, catalog language, categories, a row for each extra catalog and, at the bottom, the Project Gutenberg catalog.

The two buttons at the top right open **Display & accessibility** (section 9) and **About**, which shows where books come from and the licences of the fonts.

3 Finding books

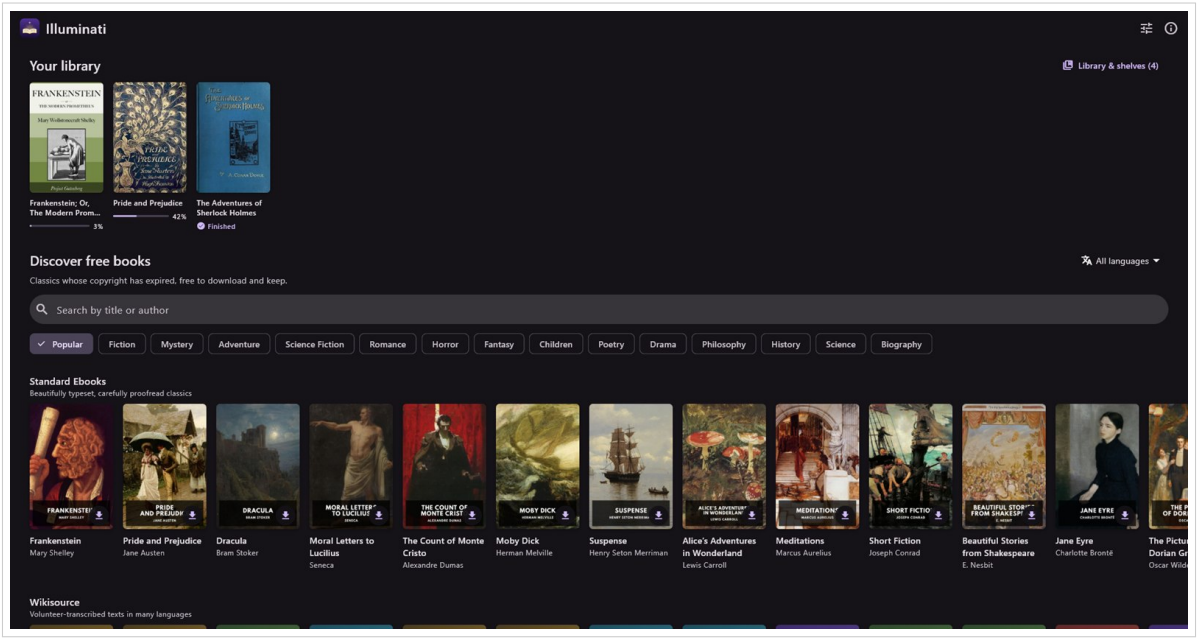


Figure 1: The home screen.

3.1 Searching

Type in **Search by title or author**. The search:

- matches any part of a title or author name: *miserab* finds *Les Misérables*;
- ignores accents and capitals: *misérable* and MISERABLE give the same results;
- searches every catalog at once; each catalog shows its matches in its own row.

Clear the box with the × button to return to the popular books.

3.2 Categories and language

The chips under the search box (**Fiction**, **Mystery**, **Science Fiction**, **Poetry**…) narrow every catalog to one subject. The language menu on the right shows only books in one language, or **All languages**. A catalog with nothing for the chosen language or category is hidden.

3.3 The catalogs

Catalog	What it offers
Project Gutenberg	The largest free library, over 75,000 books, sorted by popularity. Often available in an illustrated edition.
Standard Ebooks	Carefully proofread classics with beautiful typography, in English.
Wikisource	Texts transcribed by volunteers, in many languages. The e-book is prepared when you download it; very long works (for example novels in several volumes) may not be available.
Internet Archive	Scans of old printed editions, published 95 or more years ago. The text was made automatically from the scans and may contain errors.

3.4 A book's page

Tap a cover to open the book's page. It shows the summary, subjects, language and catalog, and a note about copyright. From here you can:

- **Download free**: the book is saved on your device, ready to read offline. A small download button also appears on every cover in the catalog.
- **Read now** or **Continue reading**, once it is downloaded.
- **Want to read**, **Finished** and **Add to shelf**, even before downloading (section 4).
- **Get illustrated edition**, for Gutenberg books you downloaded without pictures.

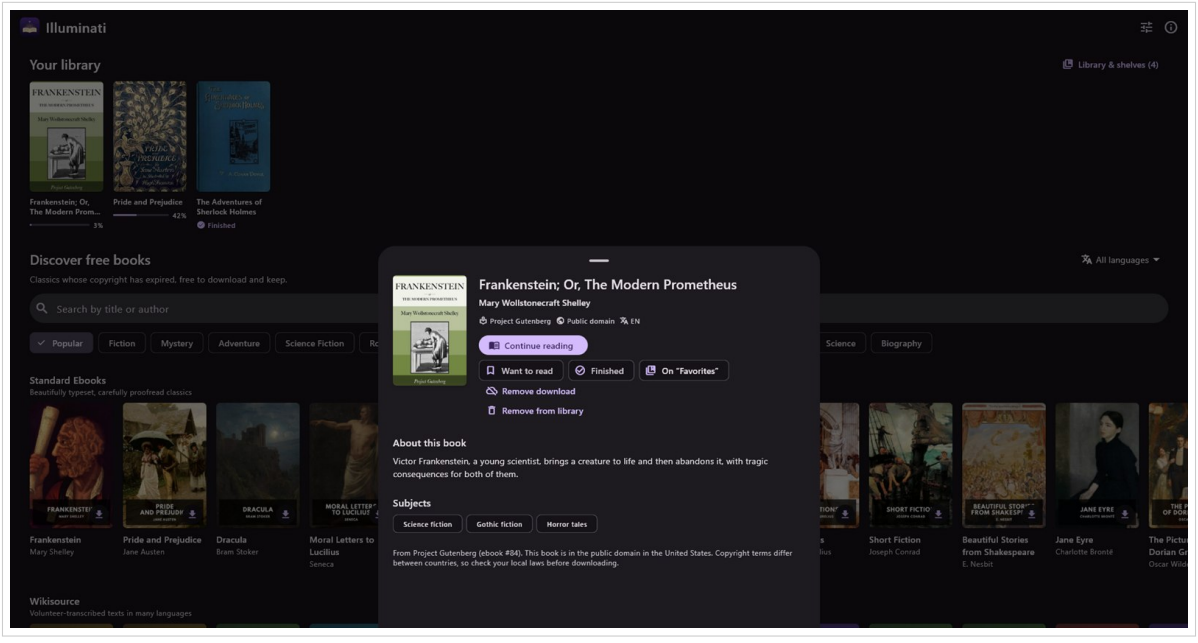


Figure 2: A book's page.

4 Your library

Library & shelves on the home screen opens every book you have saved: downloaded books and books you saved for later without downloading (shown with a dimmed cover and a cloud).

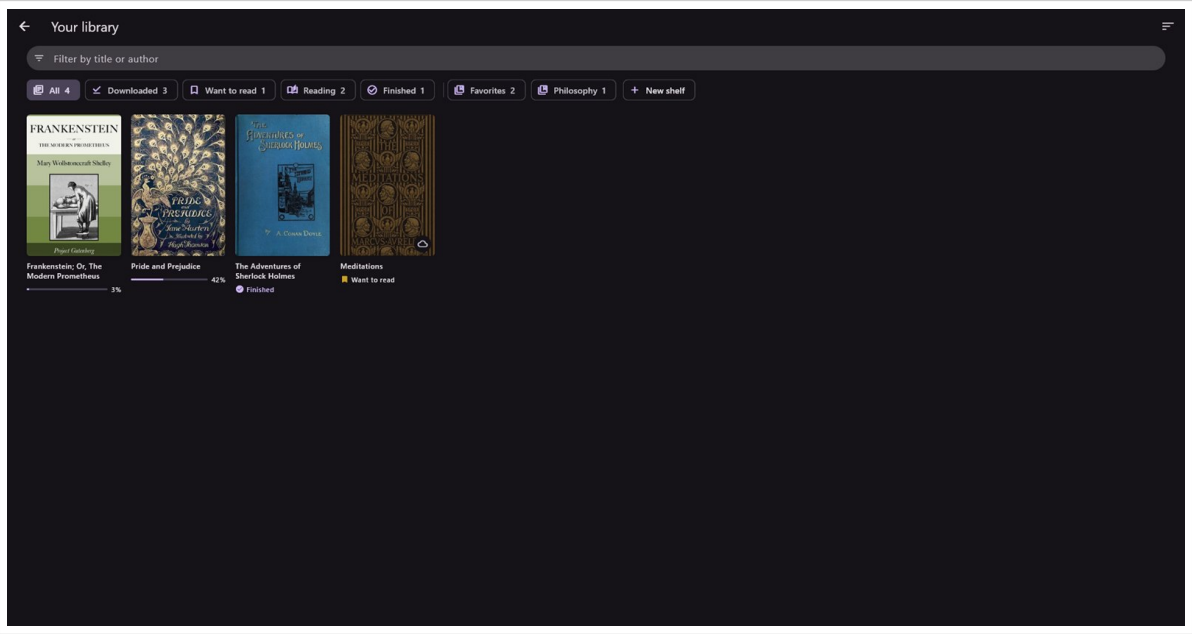


Figure 3: The library, with its views and shelves.

4.1 Views, filter and sorting

The chips at the top show a view, each with the number of books: **All**, **Downloaded**, **Want to read**, **Reading**, **Finished**, and then each of your shelves. The box above them filters by title or author. The sort button (top right) orders the books by **Recently read**, **Title**, **Author** (by surname), **Progress** or **Recently added**. The app remembers your choice.

4.2 Reading lists

- **Want to read** saves a book for later, without downloading it. Opening the book removes it from this list.
- **Finished** is set automatically when you reach the end of a book (you can undo it), or by hand.

4.3 Shelves

Shelves are your own collections, such as *Favorites* or *Philosophy*. A book can be on several shelves.

- Create one with **New shelf** in the library, or from **Add to shelf** on any book.
- Right-click (or long-press) a shelf to rename or delete it. Deleting a shelf keeps its books in your library.

4.4 The book menu

Right-click a book (or long-press it on a phone) for **Book details**, **Add to shelf**, **Want to read**, **Mark as finished** and two ways of removing it:

- **Remove download** frees the space but keeps the book in your library, with its notes, shelves and reading position.
- **Remove from library** removes everything, including notes and bookmarks.

5 Reading

Tap a downloaded book to open it. It opens where you left off.

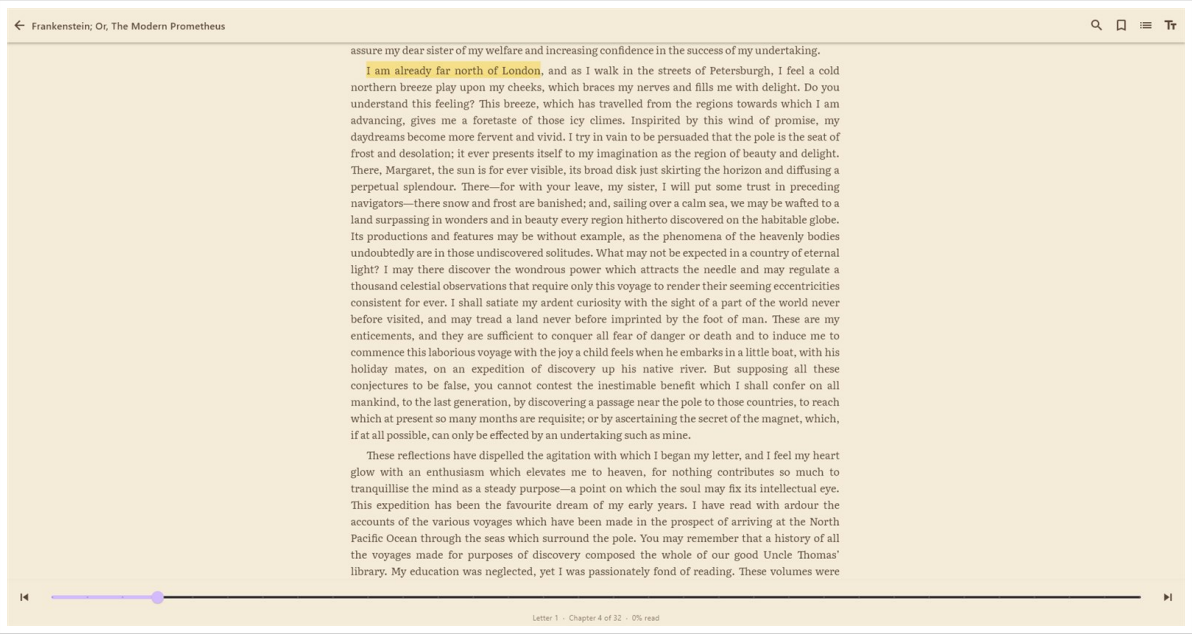


Figure 4: The reader with its toolbar.

5.1 Turning pages

Action	How
Next page	Tap the right edge · → · Page Down · Space
Previous page	Tap the left edge · ← · Page Up
Scroll a little	↑ ↓ or the mouse wheel
Show the toolbar	Tap the middle of the page

5.2 The toolbar

Tap the middle of the page to show it. At the top: back to the library, search (section 8), bookmark, contents and display settings. At the bottom: previous and next chapter, a slider to jump between chapters, and your progress.

5.3 Progress and time left

The bottom line shows how many minutes are left in the chapter and how far you are in the book. The time is based on your own reading speed, which the app learns as you read.

5.4 Contents and pictures

Contents lists the book's real chapters, even when a file holds several of them. Pictures appear in the text; tap one to see it full screen and zoom in.

6 Highlights, notes and bookmarks

6.1 Selecting text

On a phone, long-press a word and drag the handles. On a computer, drag over the text or double-click a word, then **right-click** the selection. A menu appears with:

- **Highlight**: marks the text in your highlight colour.
- **Note**: a highlight with your own note, and a choice of four colours.
- **Define** and **Translate** (section 7).
- **Copy**.

Highlights snap to whole words. Highlights with a note are underlined. Select a highlighted passage again to edit its note or remove it.

6.2 Bookmarks

Use the bookmark button in the toolbar, or Ctrl+B. A red ribbon shows that the page is bookmarked.

6.3 The side panel

The **Contents** button opens a panel with three tabs: **Contents**, **Bookmarks** and **Notes**. Tap any entry to jump to it. **Copy all as Markdown** copies all your highlights and notes, ready to paste into another program.

7 Dictionary and translation

Select a word (up to three words) and choose **Define** to see its definitions. Definitions in the book's language are shown first. They come from Wiktionary and are written in English.

Select any passage and choose **Translate**. Choose the target language from the list; the app remembers it.

Internet needed

Definitions and translations need an internet connection. The selected text is sent to Wiktionary or MyMemory; nothing else is sent.

8 Searching inside a book

Press Ctrl+F or use the search button in the toolbar, and type at least two letters. The search ignores capitals and accents. Choose a result to jump to it. A bar at the top shows 3 of 27: use its arrows, or F3, to go to the next result. Esc closes it.

9 Display and accessibility

Open it with the sliders button on the home screen, or the text button in the reader. A preview at the top shows each change as you make it.

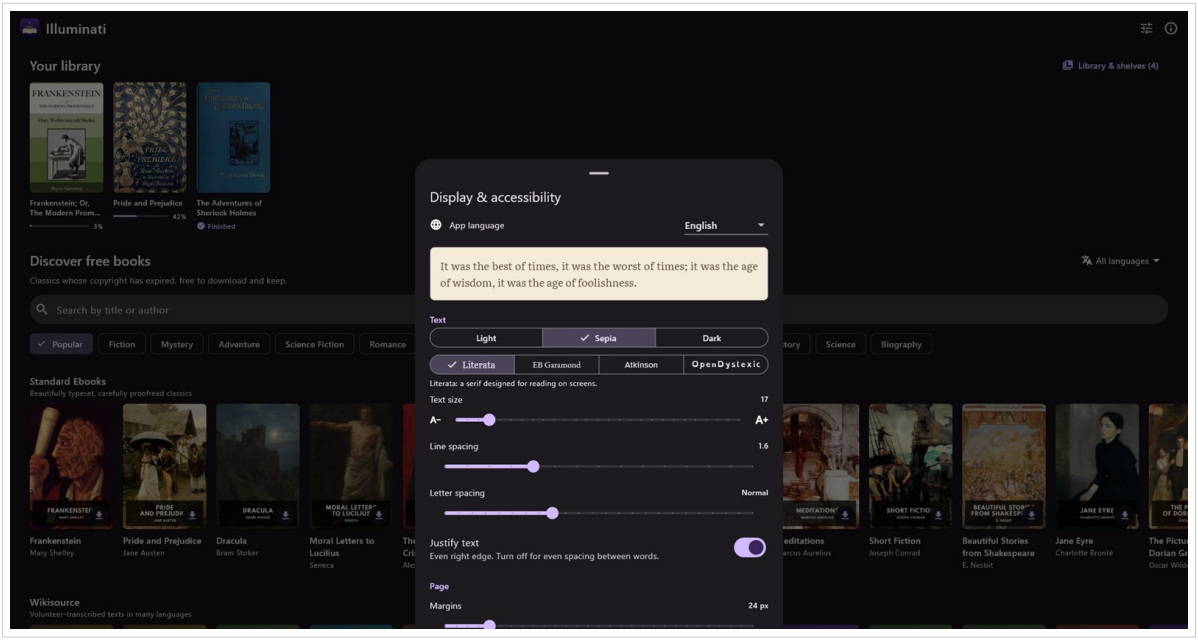


Figure 5: Display and accessibility.

9.1 Language

App language switches the interface to English, Spanish, French, German, Italian or Portuguese at once. **Same as device** follows your device's language.

9.2 Text

- **Theme**: light, sepia or dark.
- **Font**: four fonts included with the app, so books look the same on every device:
  - **Literata**, designed for reading on screens (the default);
  - EB Garamond, a classic book face;
  - Atkinson Hyperlegible, designed so that similar letters are easy to tell apart;
  - OpenDyslexic, designed for readers with dyslexia.
- **Text size**, **Line spacing** and **Letter spacing**.
- **Justify text**: turn it off for even spacing between words, which many readers with dyslexia find easier.

9.3 Page

Margins and **Line width**. Shorter lines are easier to follow.

9.4 Screen

Brightness dims the whole app. **Warmth** reduces blue light, like a night mode. Both work on top of your device's own settings.

Reset to defaults restores all these settings.

10 Keyboard shortcuts

Keys	Action
→ Page Down Space	Next page
← Page Up	Previous page
↑ ↓	Scroll a little
Ctrl+F	Search in the book
F3	Next search result
Ctrl+B	Bookmark the page, or remove the bookmark
Esc	Close search or the toolbar, or go back to the library
Shift + arrows	Extend a text selection

11 Privacy and your data

Illuminati has no account and no tracking. Your library, notes and settings are stored only on your device (on Windows, in `%APPDATA%\Illuminati`).

The app connects to the internet only to:

- browse and search the catalogs and download books and covers;
- define or translate text you selected, which is sent to Wiktionary or MyMemory.

12 About copyright

All books are in the public domain in the United States. Some Wikisource texts are instead under free licences (such as CC BY-SA), which allow you to read and share them freely. From the Internet Archive, only books published 95 or more years ago are listed.

Check your local laws

Copyright terms differ between countries. A book that is free in the United States may still be protected where you live, so check your local laws before downloading.

13 Troubleshooting

Message	What to do
Couldn't reach a catalog	The service may be busy or your connection down. Use **Try again** later; the other catalogs keep working.
This title has no e-book edition	It is probably an audio book. Look for another edition.
Wikisource could not prepare this book	The work is too long for Wikisource's service. Try one of its volumes, or another catalog.
The free daily translation limit has been reached	MyMemory allows a limited number of free translations per day. Try again tomorrow.
The download took too long	Check your connection and try again.

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